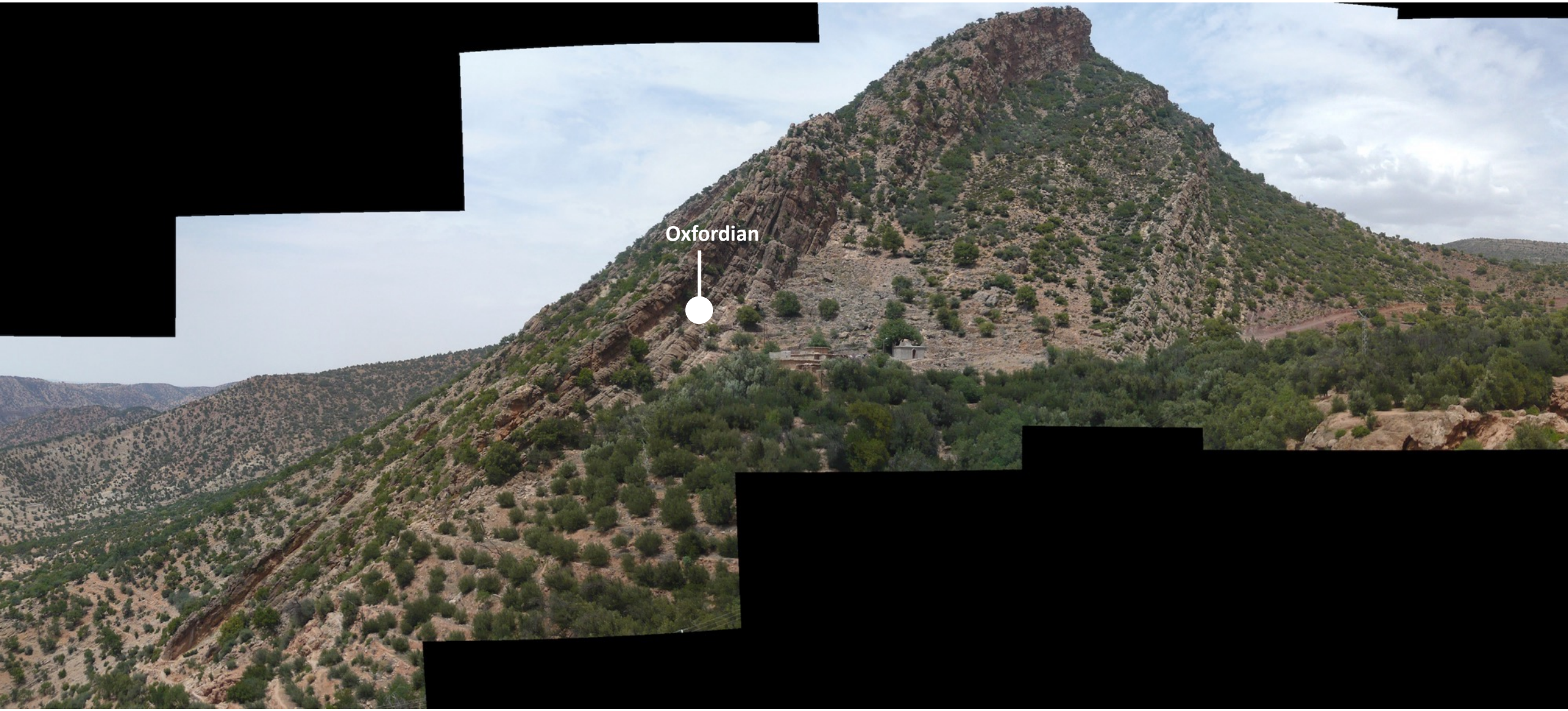
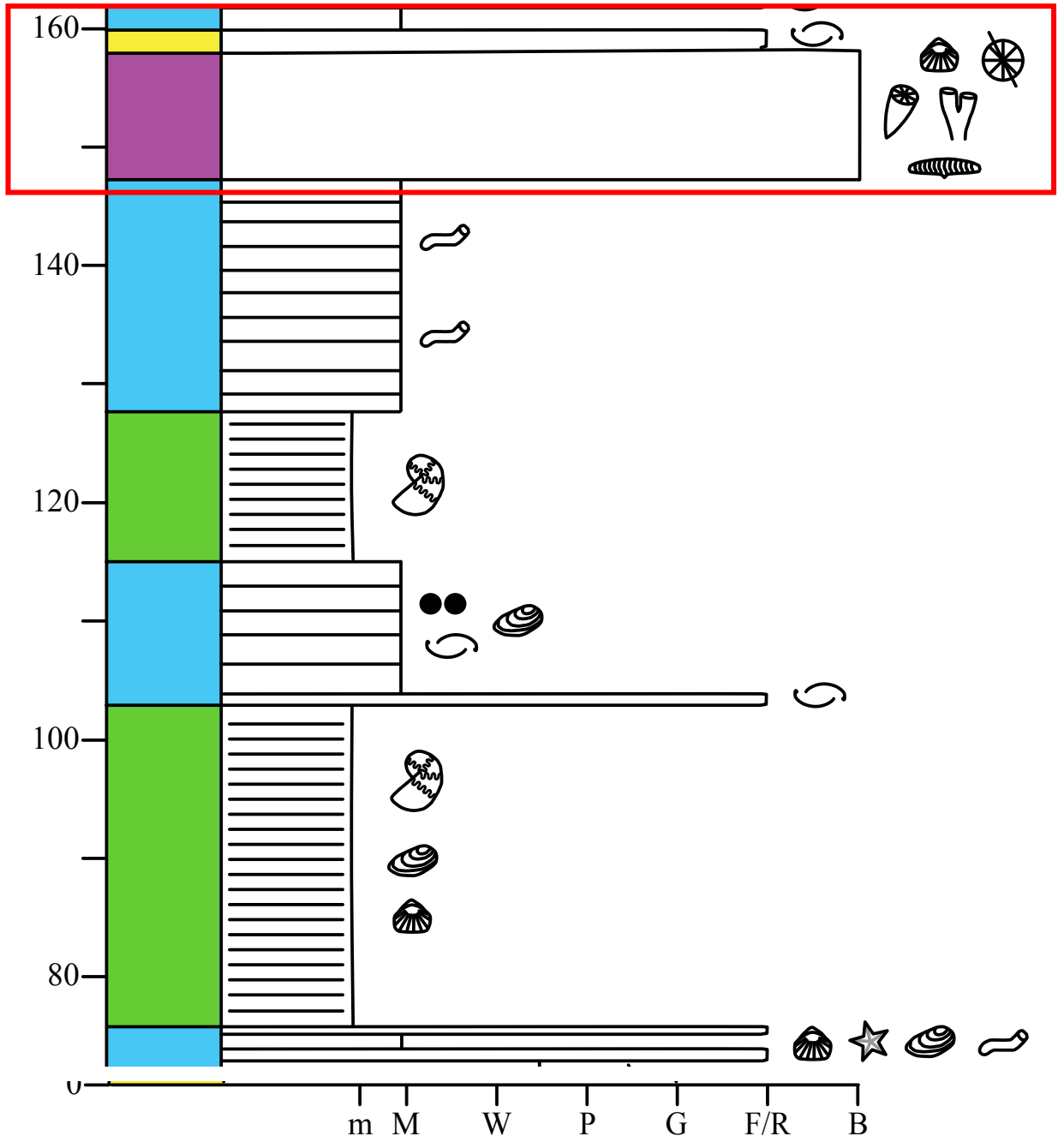
Outcrop overview



Unit 4: Oxfordian

Study the following images.
What were depositional processes and environment for this unit?



Outcrop appearance (HS)

(4.1)



(4.2)

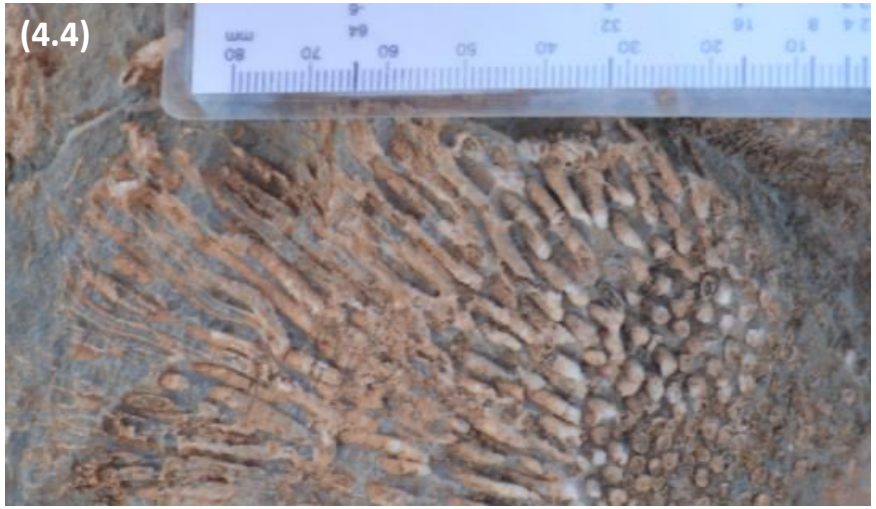


(4.3)

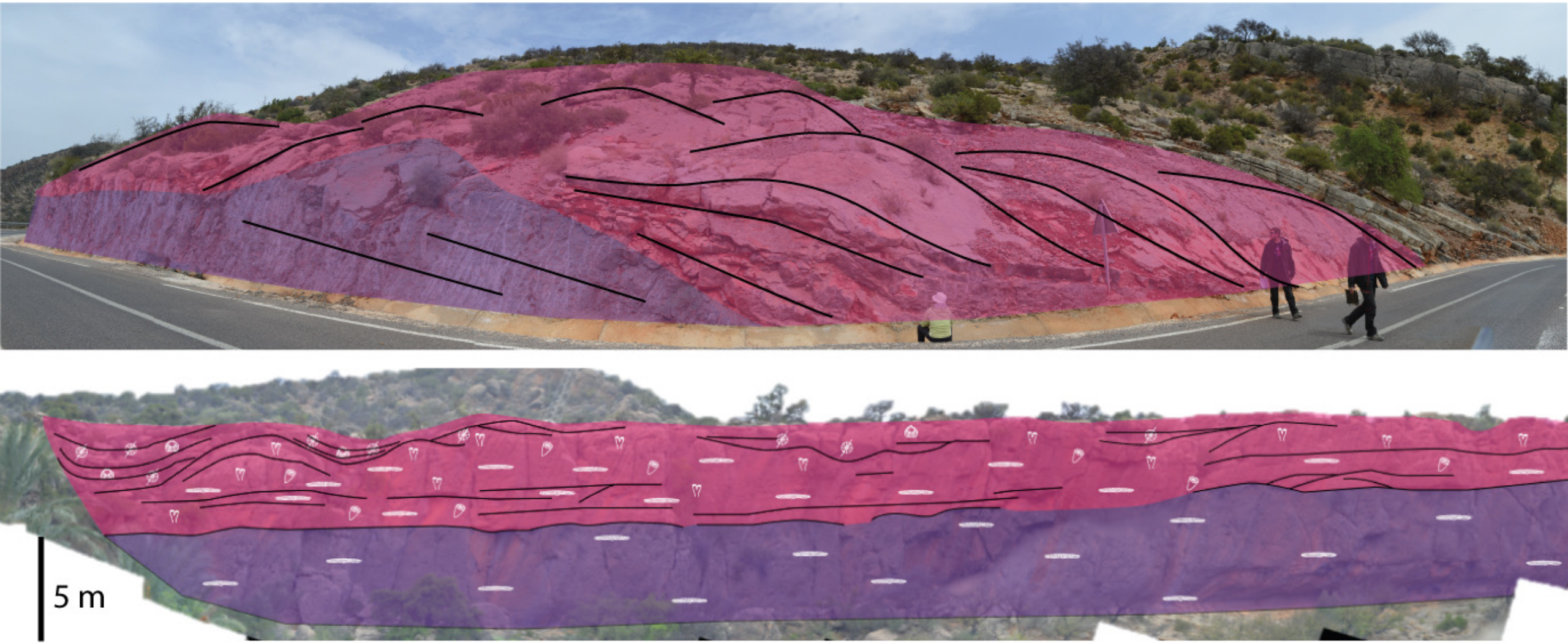


The marl member is capped by more massive dolomites and limestones. What is the main constituent here? - corals

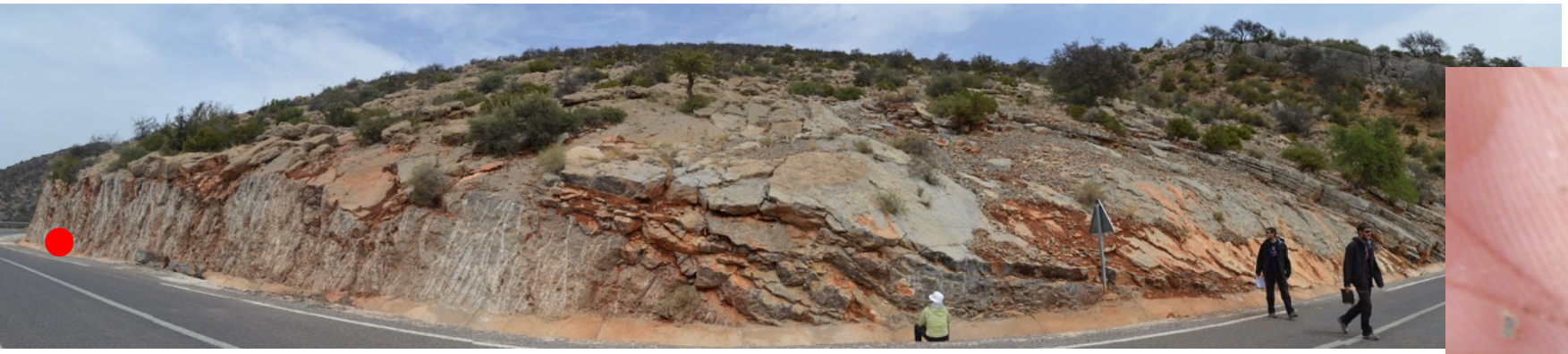
(4.4)



Outcrop appearance (HS)



Outcrop appearance (HS)









Constituents in the buildup are vertically zoned.
Zone 1 at base

Crinoids, sponges

Outcrop appearance (HS)

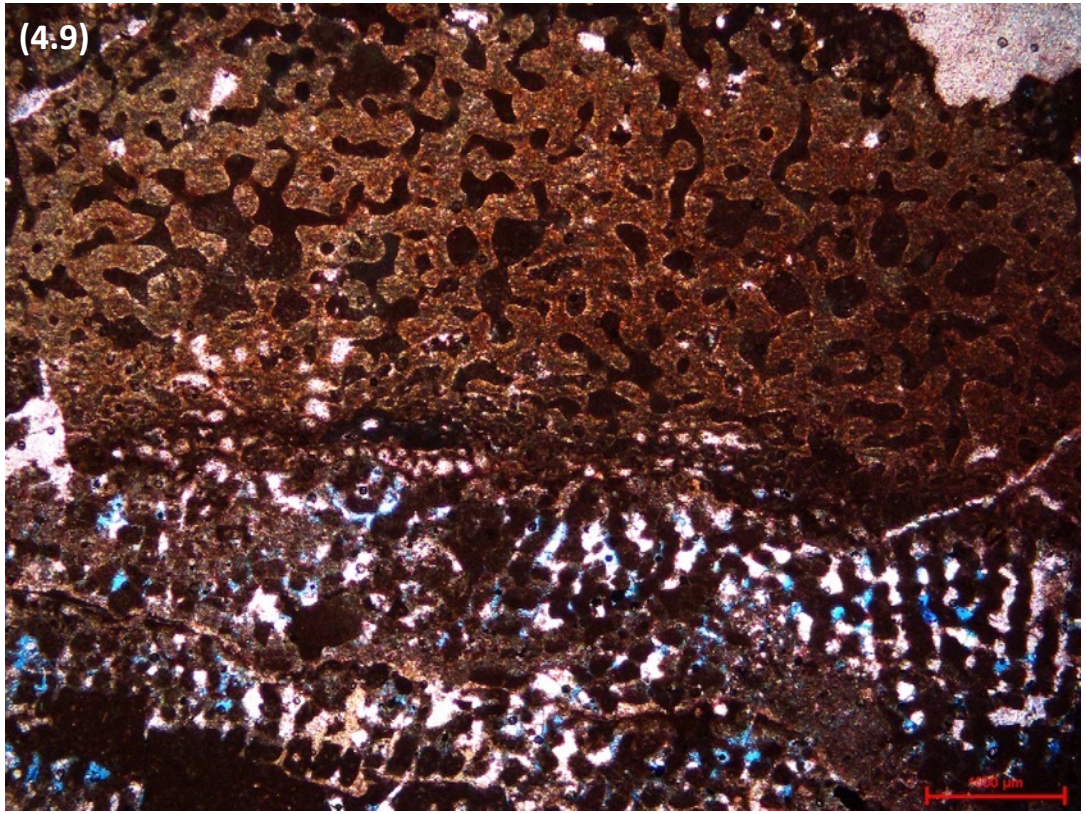


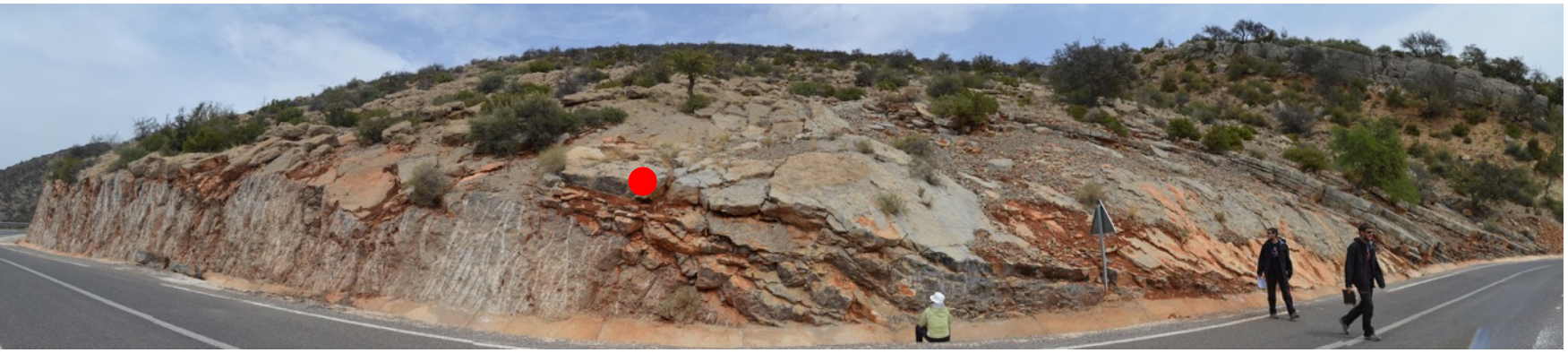
Zone 2 middle



Constituents in the buildup are vertically zoned.
Zone 2 middle

Flat/platy corals (microsolenids)

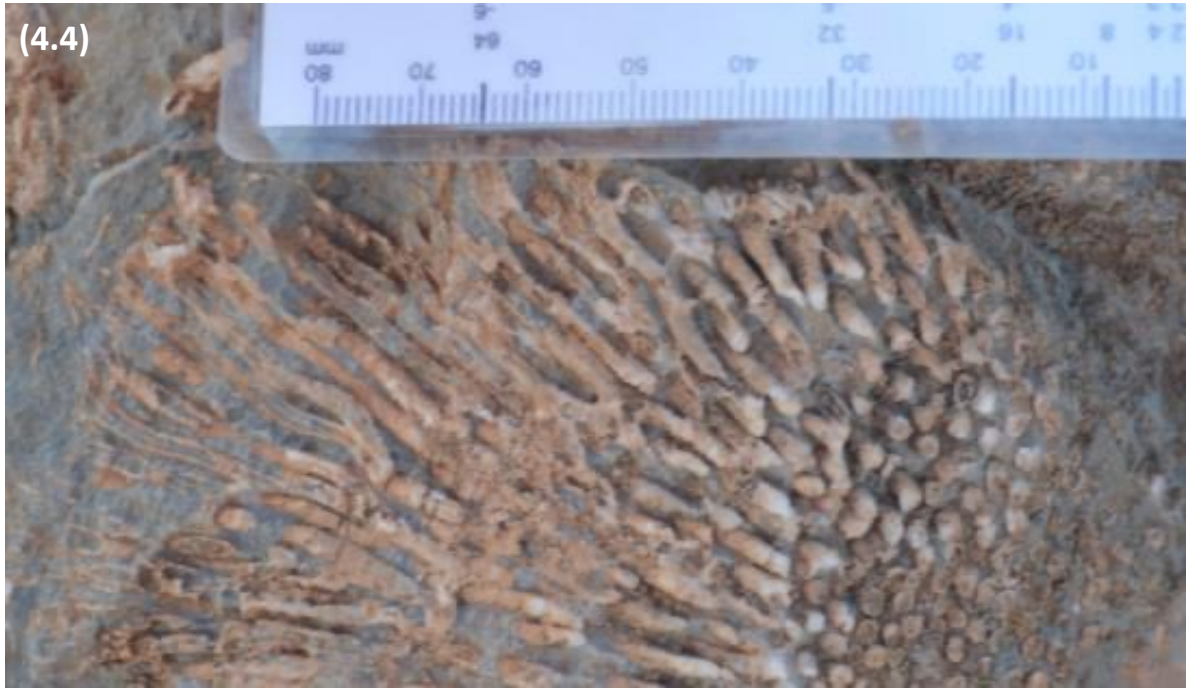




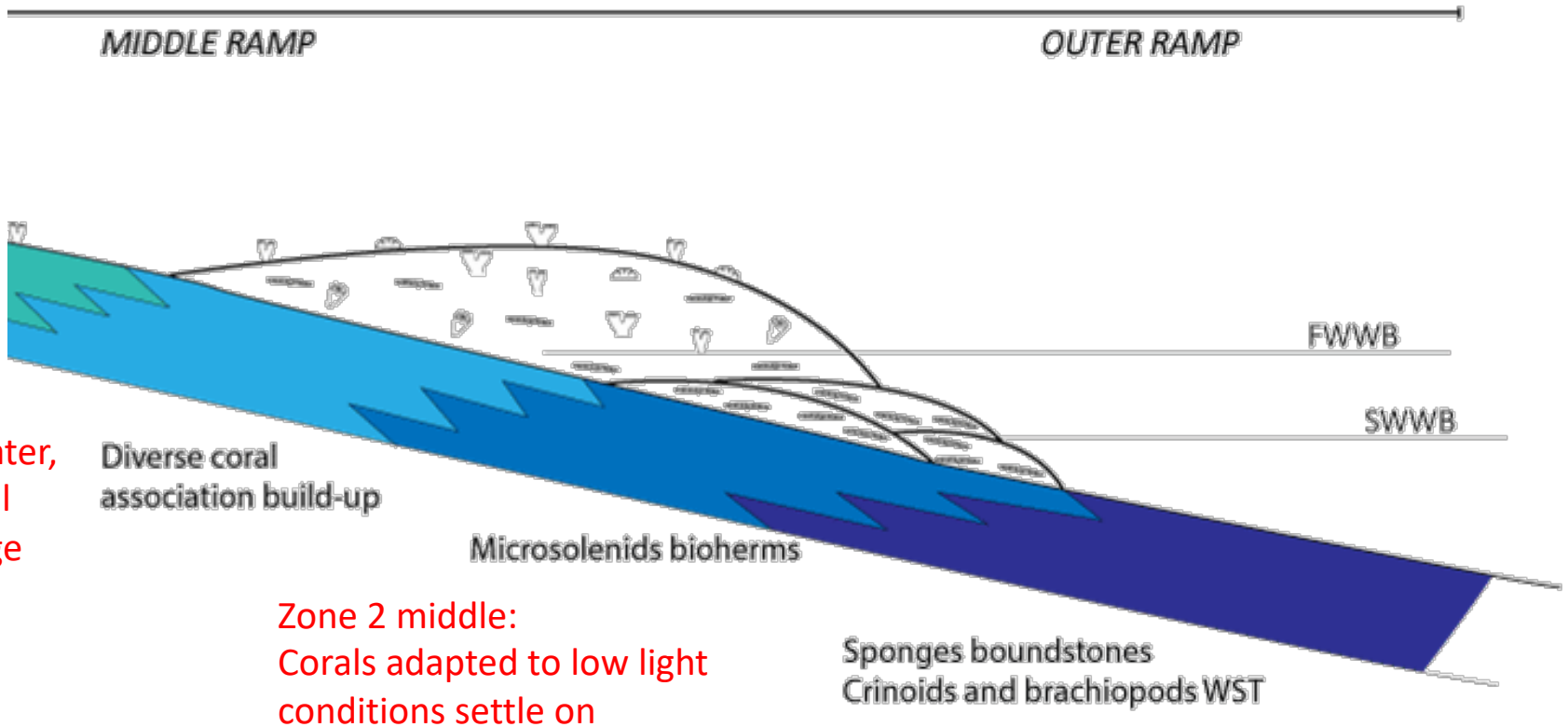
Zone 3 top

Branching corals, overall more diverse





Unit 4: Oxfordian



Zone 3 top:
Buildup grows into shallower water, whicgh favors more diverse coral community – diversification stage

Zone 2 middle:
Corals adapted to low light conditions settle on hardened substrate

Zone 3 base:
Colonization of muddy substrate by crinoids and sponges (low light communities) => stabilization – pioneer communities

Ecological succession